

Give a man a match,
and he will be warm for an hour.
Set a man on fire,
and he will be warm
for the rest of his life.

The latest round of revisions

Okay, so I've done a select few things, like thickening: VWYvwy; smoothening: PDQOGB, and that sort of thing. I appreciate your sentiments regarding my R, but after you advised me to make it proportioned more like the B, I tried many different ways to do that, and every one of them looked bad. I still have one in the florin's space. It looks like: R. It has no connection with anything else in the font. This font was built around large bowls, and large they will remain. Though I did make it—and the Y— a little smaller on top, to add character.

•Romantic Radiology

•Romantic Radiology

Maybe it's nicer of its own accord, but it doesn't work at all.

So far, in regards to your inquiry as to whether I have digitized any other designs, the only other font I've started is one that I didn't even sketch out beforehand. It's called "Yoshiko", and I've spent perhaps one or two hours total on it, and I don't think I even have quite twenty-six characters. it looks like this, in case you were wondering.

I don't have any more of the story prepared, and I just don't feel a lot like writing any of it at the moment—it's kind of a lazy day. So instead, I'm going to skip down to the next page and give you a recent English paper I did. By the way, would you happen to have any idea as to why Word won't make my quotes curly or my hyphens into dashes?

•I haven't started the italic yet, so I've substituted underlines.

•My PDF maker (PDF995) still mysteriously refuses to let me use ligatures.

The Philosophy of Aldo Leopold

Aldo Leopold's book A Sand County Almanac was first published in 1949. Even then, it was recognized that the areas of the world that could be called "wilderness" were shrinking, and that something had to be done about it. Leopold wrote what he felt that was.

The first problem, he decided, is that nobody really knows what land is. The typical thinking goes, "Land is what's out there, where there aren't any houses. That part of the land is your land, and this part is my land. I can use it for growing things, or I can use it to put up buildings, or I can use it to do whatever else I decide to do." But that's not right. Land isn't something that people are in charge of, land is something that people are part of. It's a community: everything works together. Starting with the soil itself, there's a pyramid of dependencies that reaches all the way up to the top of the food chain. The plants and trees depend on the nutrients in the ground; the mice depend on the plants and the birds depend on the trees; the owls and snakes depend on the birds and mice. Man is just part of the community, not something aloof, watching it all. And as soon as people see that land doesn't need to be protected just because protecting it is something that ought to be done, but rather because preserving it is essential to the endurance of the entire community, including people, it will happen.

When Leopold wrote, that hadn't happened, and it still hasn't. People insist on seeing the land community as something they can fool around with. For example, take a forest hill. The hill is naturally a finely balanced mechanism: the wolves eat the deer, the deer eat from the trees, the trees live off the soil. Then, some people come along. They decide that they don't want any wolves around. They reason that if there are no wolves to eat the deer, there will be plenty of deer, a hunter's paradise! But soon there are too many deer. They strip the trees bare as high as they can reach. And of course, it follows that the trees won't be able to keep as much soil from sliding away, in their diminished capacity. Now the wolf, deer, and tree populations, not to mention all the populations that depend on those ones (that is, all of them), are severely out of whack, and the land itself is running off into the river. This is what happens when people think as though they're in charge of the land and not part of the land.

The reason people don't know what land is, Leopold wrote, isn't that they don't get out in it. Indeed, almost everyone goes out for a walk in the woods every now and then. The reason is that when they go out, they don't get the full effect. For them, a hike is just a hike, not an opportunity to get back down to where it all started and see the community working. People are inclined to see things as useful or not useful, and wilderness falls under the category of not useful. The problem, therefore, lies not in the inaccessibility of wilderness or in the fact that people don't get out enough, but rather in the way it's perceived. Even with an entire world of forests and streams, people will fall short of dissolving into the land if they don't know how to look at it. So, instead of making the wilderness more accessible, we have to teach perception. Only when perception is learned will man strike a true chord with the rest of the world and understand that he is, in fact, part of nature. This is what has to be done. Now we have to work on doing it.